



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Customer Relations

QUICK SERVE RESTAURANT MANAGEMENT SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the nature of positive customer relations.
2. Demonstrate a customer service mindset.
3. Determine ways of reinforcing the company's image through employee performance.
4. Reinforce service orientation through communication.
5. Explain the nature of customer service in the hospitality and tourism industry.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the assistant manager at SUNNY EATS, a fast-casual restaurant specializing in sandwiches, salads, and smoothies. The restaurant is located in a popular tourist area, so it experiences significant foot traffic, especially during the busy summer season. The general manager (judge) wants you to develop strategies to improve customer relations during peak times when service issues and long wait times become common.

SUNNY EATS is popular with both locals and tourists due to its fresh, healthy menu and quick service. However, during peak lunch and dinner hours, the restaurant struggles with long lines, slow service, and frustrated customers. Complaints have increased about delays in food preparation, incorrect orders, and a lack of seating during busy hours. While the staff usually apologizes and corrects mistakes, customer satisfaction is still low, and negative reviews are starting to appear online.

The general manager (judge) has asked you to create a plan to address these customer service issues. Your strategies should focus on reducing wait times, improving communication between staff and customers, and ensuring that even during the busiest hours, customers leave with a positive experience. You should also suggest ways for staff to handle customer complaints effectively and prevent future issues.

You will present your strategies to the general manager (judge) in a role-play to take place in the general manager's (judge's) office. The general manager (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your ideas and answered the general manager's (judge's) questions, the general manager (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. What specific strategies did you implement to reduce wait times during peak hours, and how will these changes improve overall service efficiency?
2. How do you plan to improve communication between the staff and customers during busy times to minimize frustration and manage expectations?

Did the participant:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the nature of positive customer relations?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Demonstrate a customer service mindset?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Determine ways of reinforcing the company's image through employee performance?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Reinforce service orientation through communication?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Explain the nature of customer service in the hospitality and tourism industry?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						